Layla Drummond

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Professional Summary

Early cybersecurity professional pursuing a B.S. in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance at WGU, with CompTIA A+, Network+, Security+, Project+, and ITIL 4 Foundation certifications. Hands-on experience building Splunk detections, Python log analysis and phishing triage tools, and automated incident workflows. Technical coach skilled in troubleshooting, documentation, and explaining complex concepts to diverse users.

Core Competencies

Security Operations:	Security event monitoring, alert triage, initial incident response, log review, email header and IOC analysis, incident documentation, ticketing workflows, threat detection fundamentals
Security Tools:	Splunk, SPL, Wireshark, Nmap, Autopsy, VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB, SIEM operations, network traffic analysis, detection engineering
Networking:	TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, OSI model, VPNs, network segmentation, firewalls, IDS/IPS concepts, troubleshooting
Systems:	Windows, Linux, command-line fundamentals, systemd service management
Scripting & Automation:	Python, regex, unittest, PowerShell, Java, Paramiko/SSH automation, REST API integration, Git/GitHub/GitLab
Frameworks:	MITRE ATT&CK framework, risk management concepts, security best practices
Professional Skills:	Technical coaching, written and verbal communication, customer service, collaboration, confidentiality, adaptability

Certifications

CompTIA Security+ (2026) | **Network+** (2025) | **A+** (2025)
CompTIA Project+ (2025) | **ITIL 4 Foundation** (2025)

Education

Western Governors University **Expected Dec 2027**
Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance *Salt Lake City, UT*

- Completed 76 competency units toward degree program.
- Relevant coursework: Network Security, Digital Forensics, Information Security, Legal Issues in Information Security, and IT Project Management.

Projects

Automated Phishing Triage and Help Desk Integration **Home Lab Project**

- Built a Python CLI to analyze reported phishing emails in `.eml` format, parse SPF/DKIM/DMARC results, and extract URLs, domains, sender IPs, and attachment hashes for investigation.
- Integrated VirusTotal and AbuseIPDB reputation lookups with caching, rate limiting, and per-message lookup budgets; generated explainable verdicts from authentication, impersonation, suspicious content, and reputation signals.
- Automated ticket payload generation with MITRE ATT&CK mappings, defanged indicators, scoring rationale, and recommended response actions; demonstrated the workflow with an enriched phishing report captured in Raiseaticket.
- Implemented duplicate-ticket prevention and 46 automated tests covering parsing, scoring, enrichment, and ticketing, including mocked API errors and a local help desk round-trip.

Python Authentication Log Analyzer **Home Lab Project**
github.com/NaviSleepy/auth-log-analyzer

- Built a dependency-free Python CLI using regex to parse authentication logs and reproduce three Splunk detections; validated results against the same 180-event dataset.
- Detected failure bursts, successful logons after repeated failures, and password spraying using per-account and per-source correlation; assigned severity from behavior and source scope.
- Used sliding 10-minute windows to prevent time-bucket boundary misses and interval-variance analysis to distinguish scripted attempts from human retries.
- Wrote 24 unit tests covering parser validation, thresholds, window expiry, and password-spraying detection gaps; implemented standard exit codes for scheduled and pipeline use.

Splunk Authentication Log Investigation **Home Lab Project**

github.com/NaviSleepy/splunk-auth-investigation

- Ingested and validated 180 authentication events in Splunk, then built three SPL detections using `stats`, `bin`, and `streamstats` with a sliding time window to correlate failed and successful logons across two servers.
- Identified password guessing (18 failures followed by a successful logon from the same source), password spraying (one source attempting 10 accounts in under three minutes), and a stale service-account credential; mapped findings to MITRE ATT&CK T1110.001, T1110.003, and T1078.
- Discovered a detection gap where the per-account burst rule missed the spraying pattern entirely, and wrote a companion rule counting distinct accounts per source to close it; the gap is now enforced as a regression test in the Python analyzer above.
- Built a three-panel dashboard and documented findings with triage priorities, recommended follow-up evidence, and explicit limitations separating suspicious activity from confirmed compromise.

Network Incident Response and Monitoring Automation **Academic Project**

- Developed a Python automation suite for a simulated 16-device enterprise network in GNS3, parsing a CSV device inventory and performing scheduled ICMP availability checks with automated email alerting through `smtplib`.
- Automated detection and remediation of unauthorized DNS changes by connecting to Linux servers over SSH with Paramiko, comparing live BIND and `resolv.conf` settings against an approved baseline, correcting drift, and verifying the fix.
- Integrated a help desk REST API to programmatically open and update tickets capturing device hostname, IP address, issue type, and status across the full detect, alert, remediate, and resolve incident lifecycle.
- Implemented timestamped per-device configuration backups and structured logging of DNS service state; managed the codebase in GitLab with function-scoped commits documenting each delivery phase.

Work Experience

Western Governors University **Aug. 2024 – Present**

Peer Coach Intern / Peer Tutor *Remote*

- Coach 20+ students per month through cybersecurity and IT coursework, including network security fundamentals, troubleshooting, certification preparation, and security concepts.
- Support student readiness for CompTIA A+, Network+, and related IT certification exams by explaining technical concepts, study strategies, and problem-solving methods.
- Maintain a 4.8/5.0 student satisfaction rating across 80+ virtual coaching sessions, demonstrating strong communication, empathy, and technical support skills.
- Protect sensitive student information and collaborate with faculty and peer coaches to develop IT and cybersecurity learning resources.

VXI Global Solutions **July 2022 – Dec. 2022**

Customer Service / Call Center Representative *Remote*

- Assisted customers by troubleshooting account, service, and basic technical issues while maintaining professionalism in a fast-paced, high-volume environment.
- Documented customer interactions accurately in CRM systems, escalated complex issues appropriately, and followed data protection protocols.

ERC **Sept. 2019 – Jan. 2020**

Administrative Assistant / Office Support *Remote*

- Managed scheduling, records, data entry, email communication, and administrative tasks to support daily operations.
- Maintained organized documentation and handled confidential information with accuracy, discretion, and professionalism.